

FORGE Phase 1 • Week 11 • Session 32 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 32: Self-Assessment and Reflection" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: formentors.org/media.html

Session 32 as written runs about 110 minutes (10 + 25 + 25 + 40 + 10). This insert adds one short video, which plays inside the Opening Circle, and one seven-minute talk just before the essay, which fills the session to two hours. There is no buffer: this is a quiet session, and the writing time matters more than the talk.

What's in this insert

- **Video 32A, "Self-Assessment and Reflection"** (2 min 18 s). Today in the guide's words ("Today isn't about learning something new... This is for you"), the three parts of the day, what to look for in the journal and the five entries to mark, the questionnaire's 1-to-5 scale on screen one rating at a time, "Nobody's a 5 on everything after 10 weeks," and the essay prompt. It ends on the check-in question, "Did you bring your journal? And how are you feeling about looking back at where you started?", and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **A short talk on how much people change:** Dan Gilbert, *The psychology of your future self* (TED, 2014, 6 minutes 35 seconds on TED.com; the YouTube upload runs 6:50), with discussion questions. It ends on "Human beings are works in progress that mistakenly think they're finished."

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Video 32A , then Opening Circle	10	Play it as the men sit down. It ends on the check-in question: start the round there and note who brought journals, as written. The video has given your after-round explanation of the three parts of today, so go from the round straight into the journals.
0:10	Journal Review	25	As written. Quiet, individual work.
0:35	Self-Assessment Questionnaire	25	As written. While you hand it out, you can replay 1:01 to 1:34 of Video 32A to put the 1-to-5 scale on screen.
1:00	Talk: Dan Gilbert, <i>The psychology of your future self</i>	7	Introduce it in one sentence: "A psychologist asked thousands of people how much they had changed, and how much they expected to change. Listen for what he found."
1:07	Talk discussion	3	Take one or two answers to question 1 or 3, then go straight into the essay. The other questions are good ways into it.
1:10	Self-Assessment Essay	40	As written, including the four parts of the prompt. Write in silence.
1:50	Closing	10	As written, with the homework for tomorrow's peer feedback.

If the round or the questionnaire runs long, skip the talk discussion and read question 3 aloud as the way into the essay. Do not cut the writing time.

Notes on the video

- **The video does not give the essay's four parts** (who you were on Day 1, what happened, who you are now, what's still unfinished). Read them aloud at the start of the essay, as written, so they come fresh.
- **The scale on screen is the questionnaire's own wording.** The video does not name the thirty items or the six skill areas; the handout does.

Discussion questions for the Dan Gilbert talk

1. Gilbert found that at every age, people "vastly underestimated how much change they would experience" in the next ten years. You just spent 25 minutes with your own journal. Did you change more, or less, than you would have guessed in Week 1?
2. He says most people can remember who they were but find it hard to imagine who they are going to be. Your essay asks who you were when you started and who you are now. Which part is harder to write? Why?
3. "Human beings are works in progress that mistakenly think they're finished." Where are you still a work in progress? (*That is the essay's last part: what's still unfinished.*)
4. "The person you are right now is as transient, as fleeting and as temporary as all the people you've ever been." Is that good news or hard news for you? Why?

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *The psychology of your future self* — **YouTube** (TED): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XNbR54Gpj4> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/dan_gilbert_the_psychology_of_your_future_self

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Video 32A is FORGE's own, so there is no outside license to ask for. Download it from forgementors.org/media.html onto the playback device before the session.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Video 32A loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Dan Gilbert talk loaded, previewed, and cleared under the facility's media rules
- ☐ Questionnaires and essay paper ready before the video plays